



Figure 7: The final image

must have noticed that the instant you stroke the ellipse, a line appears at the bottom. Also note that the line overlaps the inner white core, the middle white line and the transparent area between them. This doesn't look clean, so we will get rid of it. This is a tricky part and needs some understanding.

Let's start with the inner core. We have been working on the same bubble layer; so if you try to remove the line by using an eraser, you will wipe away the drawing as well. To remove the lining in the drawn part, we will use the brush. Grab the colour picker tool and make sure the bubbles layer is selected. Now click on the inner core. Because we coloured it white, it's not necessary to use the colour pick. But this trick comes handy with unknown colour codes. So grab the brush, whose colour is now set to white, and carefully clean only the area that's inside the inner core. Zoom in for maximum control.

Now we will clean the transparent/background part. Since we are working with layers and we haven't drawn anything in between the inner and the outer lines, we can use the eraser. Press **Shift+E** to evoke the eraser and carefully erase the line from the transparent/background portion, and not from the white lines.

We are almost done now. Just get the brush again and set the FG colour to white. Zoom in and remove the green line from the middle white-bordered ellipse. Continue doing this until you are satisfied. Once done, reduce the opacity to 60. The final look should resemble Figure 6 – Part 7.

This sums up the first bubble/half bubble. Thankfully, we won't have to go through the same procedure again and again. I'll make the next bubble creation simple, since we will be creating the next round of bubbles in the complete canvas.

Step 11 Create a new transparent layer and name it **Main Bubble**. Create a medium circular selection using the ellipse tool and fill it with white (Figure 7 – Part 1). The next step is pretty similar to that of the previous one. We will not go into creating many selections. So to ease your work, we will expand

the current selection. In case your selection went inactive, you can always get it working by right-clicking on the particular layer and selecting **Alpha to Selection**. When your selection becomes active, go to **Select→Grow** and increase the selection by 7. Now stroke it with white using the **Edit→Stroke** selection and with 6 as the line width. For the outermost part, increase the selection by 4 and stroke it using 4 as the line width with the FG colour set to #496623. Set the opacity to 60.

To make multiple bubbles, just duplicate the layer, reduce the layer size using the **Scale** tool (**Shift+T**) according to the resolution and move it using the **Move** tool (**m**). Continue duplicating and moving until you reach the effect as shown in Figure 7 – Part 2.

Now, grab the brush and set the FG colour to white. Then create a new layer and name it **Dots**. Varying the brush size from the **Tools** option, create multiple small and medium dots around the circle. You can even use the **Sparks** brush to give a yellow star-shaped light.

Step 12 Congratulations! We are almost done with our first assignment. Now we just need to jazz up the image a bit. Let us quickly create a new layer and name it **Middle Line**. Grab the rectangle selection tool and create a selection as shown in Figure 7 – Part 3. Now choose the **Edit→Stroke** selection and with the line radius as 2, stroke it. Right-click the layer and click on **Alpha to Selection**. Navigate to **Edit→Border** and stroke it again using **Stroke Selection** (keep 2 as the line width).

Now grab the path tool and create a path as shown in Figure 7 – Part 4. Hold the vertical line with the left mouse button pressed down and drag it to give it a curved shape. You will notice directional dotted lines, which help you provide a curve to the path. Arrange the dotted line as done in Figure 7 – Part 5. Stroke the path with 4 as the line width. Now create an arrow using either the brush tool or the path tool.

Add some text if you wish, and we are done. Thus, we created a simple, yet funky, wallpaper using nothing but four tools. Isn't it great? Keep trying out new things and do send me the results that you get. In the next tutorial, we will learn how to isolate images from various backgrounds using different techniques. I also have something very special for writers. And do not forget to get the source of this wallpaper from the LFY CD. I have also included some more sample wallpapers. Have fun, GIMPing! 

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